

Manual

Workflow for Absence Approval PZW-WFG 8.3

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1 Workflow for Absence Approval - Overview

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Purpose

Application Service for mapping a user-friendly and transparent absence approval workflow.

Implementation Considerations

You use the function package if:

- you wish to provide employees with the possibility to request absence times on PZE or BDE terminals (only available at specific terminal types).
- the relevant supervisors are to be notified if an absence was requested so that they may approve or reject the request.
- employees are to be informed, for example, when their request is approved or rejected by means of a message on the labor time recording terminal.

Integration

Requested absences are displayed in italics in [personnel scheduling](#) and can thus be considered in the planning of available employees.

Features

- Absence workflow.
 - Terminal dialog for employees to request absence times (e.g. leave, flextime...) and display their requested and approved absences at the PZE or BDE terminal.
 - Notification of the supervisor with regard to requested absence times (e.g. by e-mail).
 - Function for approving or rejecting requested absences.
 - Withdrawal by the employee of absence requests not yet processed.
 - Notification of the requesting party, e.g. at the PZE terminal or by e-mail, as to whether the absence was approved or rejected.

2 Configuration Absence Workflow

Overview

Employees can use the absence workflow to request absences via Internet and/or Intranet. When a request has been filed, the supervisor is informed and can then approve or reject the request. The employee receives a notification via e-mail or on the terminal if the absence request was approved or not.

The settings for the absence workflow are configured in different applications on the MOC:

Configuration – Basic Settings

Menu	System administration → System settings → Basic settings
Transaction code	setup
Function authorization	setup

In the tab *ESK* of the application [Basic settings](#), the e-mail server must be entered so that notifications for absence times and their approval and/or rejection can be forwarded to the employees by e-mail:

The screenshot shows the 'Basic settings' application window with the 'ESK' tab selected. The configuration fields are as follows:

Field	Value
SMTP server	smtp.bsp.intern
Port	0
Timeout	0 [ms]
Sender	automail@bsp.de
SMS path	SMS
Pager path	PAGER

Field descriptions

It is important to specify the IP address of the SMTP server and the sender of the mails that are sent.

SMTP server

To send e-mails, enter the IP address or name of the local SMTP server in the *SMTP server* field.

Sender

You can enter a central e-mail account. E-mails sent via HYDRA Escalation Management will then have this central account as sender.

Event configuration in the Escalation Management

Menu	Master data → Escalation management → Escalation configuration
Transaction code	esccfg
Function authorization	esccfg

You store the events for requesting, approving and rejecting absences in the [Escalation configuration](#):

The screenshot shows the 'Escalation configuration' window. The main table lists 16 events. The right-hand pane shows the configuration for the selected event 'DB.FILL_LEVEL_EXCEEDED'.

Reference	Event	Designation	Recipient t...	Recipient	Priority	Color	Active	ESK mode
1	DB.FILL_LE...	Fill level of ...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	1	Light red	☒	F
2	FILESYS.FI...	Fullstandsp...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	1	Light red	☒	F
3	ESK.NO_FE...	Keine Perso...	Function	Dispatcher	1	Pink	☒	F
4	MST.MALFU...	Machine ma...	Function	Instandsetz...	1	Yellow	☒	F
5	SAP.INBOU...	Keine Verbi...	Person		1	Turquoise	☒	F
6	TNR.OFFLINE	Terminal of ...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	2	Light yellow	☒	F
7	TNR.OFFLINE	Terminal of ...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	1	Light red	☒	F
8	SAP.INBOU...	min 1 Daten...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	9	Light blue	☒	F
9	SAP.INBOU...	min 1 Daten...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	9	Light blue	☒	F
10	SAP.PP_AV...	Kein Updat...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	5	Green	☒	F
11	SAP.OUTB...	Keine Verbi...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	1	Light red	☒	F
12	FZ.APPLIC...	Absence ap...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	1	Green	☒	F
13	FZ.APPLIC...	Application ...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	1	Pink	☒	F
14	FZ.APPLIC...	Application ...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	1	Turquoise	☒	F
15	ZWR.OPEN...	Entrance o...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	1	Light red	☒	F
16	ZWR.OPEN...	Entrance o...	Function	HYDRA-Ad...	1	Light red	☒	F

The right-hand pane shows the configuration for the selected event 'DB.FILL_LEVEL_EXCEEDED'.

Event	Message	Notification	Condition	Last change
Event	DB.FILL_LEVEL_EXCEEDED			
Designation	Fill level of database file groups/table spaces exceeded			
Recipient type	Function			
Recipient	HYDRA-Administrator			
Priority	1			
Color	Light red			
	☒ Active			
Cyclic monitoring				
Automatic: after reading the message				
Automatic: after closing the event				
Automatic: after sending the message				
☐ Active				
Function				
CLOSE				

Field descriptions

Event

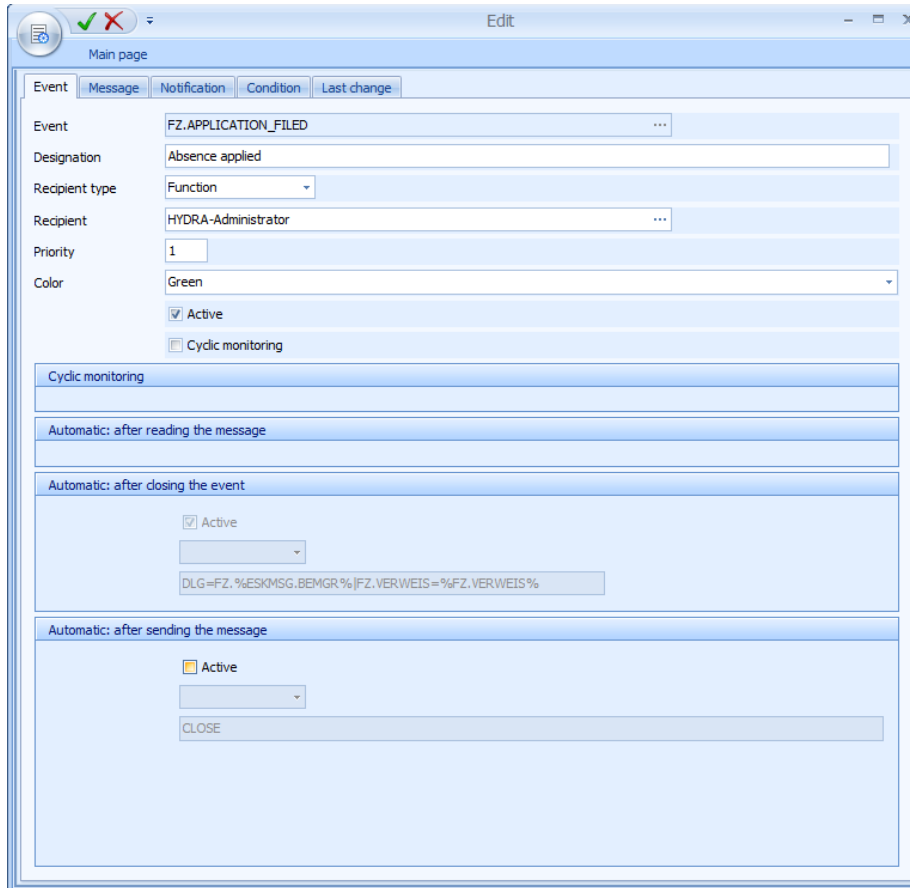
FZ.APPLICATION_FILED -> triggered when an absence is requested.

FZ.APPLICATION_ALLOWED -> triggered after approval of an absence request.

FZ.APPLICATION_REJECTED -> triggered after rejection of an absence request.

FZ.APPLICATION_WITHDRAWN -> triggered after withdrawal of an absence request by an employee.

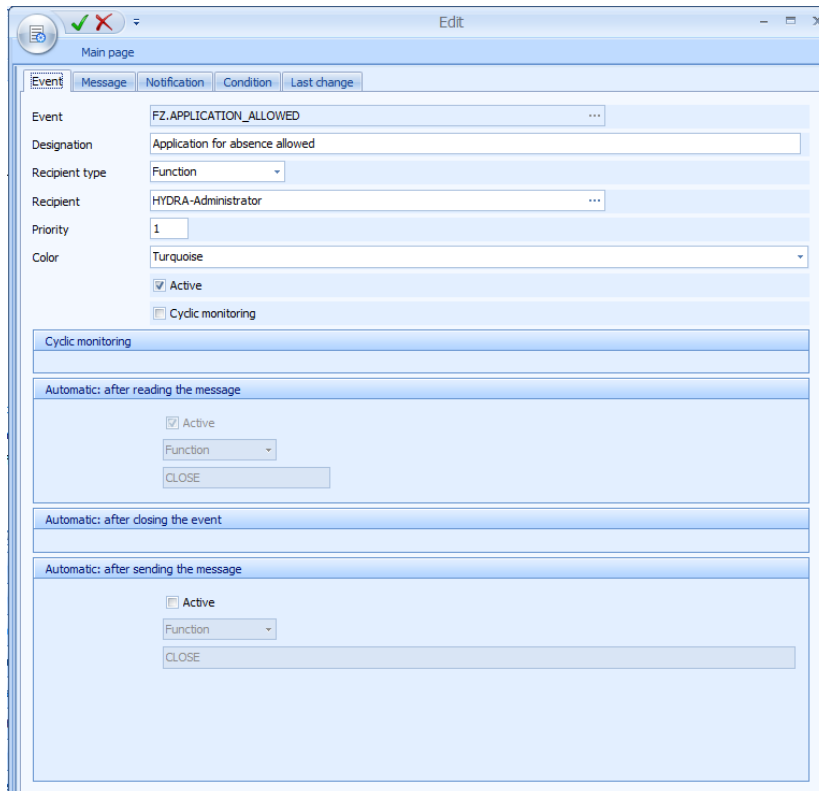
Event tab for FZ.APPLICATION_FILED



The screenshot shows the 'Event' tab configuration for the event 'FZ.APPLICATION_FILED'. The configuration includes the following fields and options:

- Event:** FZ.APPLICATION_FILED
- Designation:** Absence applied
- Recipient type:** Function
- Recipient:** HYDRA-Administrator
- Priority:** 1
- Color:** Green
- Active:** ☒
- Cyclic monitoring:** ☐
- Cyclic monitoring:** (Section header)
- Automatic: after reading the message:** (Section header)
- Automatic: after closing the event:**
 - Active:** ☒
 - DLG:** FZ. %ESKMSG.BEMGR%|FZ.VERWEIS=%FZ.VERWEIS%
- Automatic: after sending the message:**
 - Active:** ☐
 - CLOSE:** (Text field)

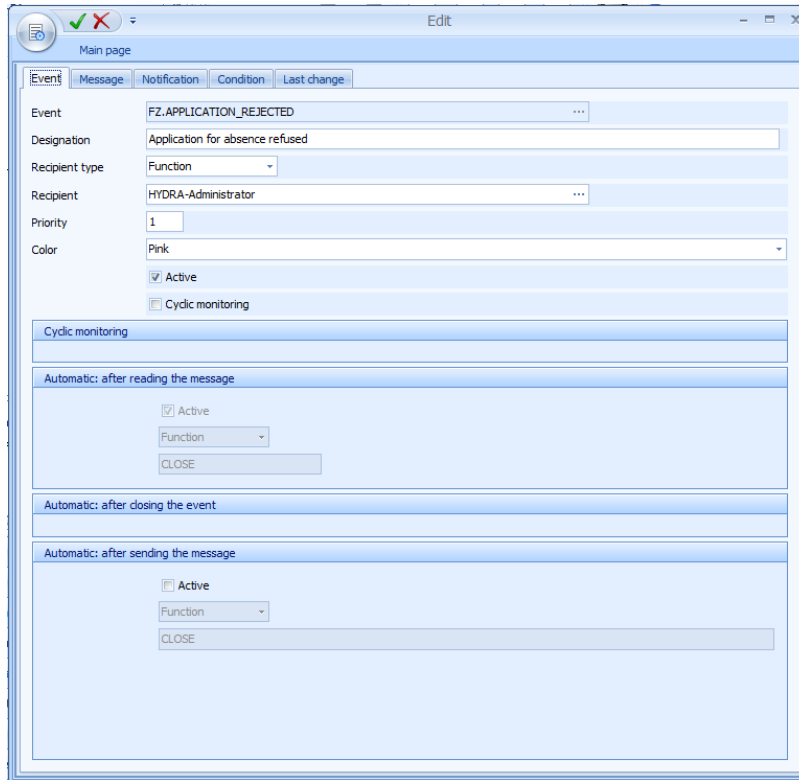
Event tab for FZ.APPLICATION_ALLOWED



The screenshot shows the 'Event' tab configuration for the event 'FZ.APPLICATION_ALLOWED'. The configuration includes the following fields and options:

- Event:** FZ.APPLICATION_ALLOWED
- Designation:** Application for absence allowed
- Recipient type:** Function
- Recipient:** HYDRA-Administrator
- Priority:** 1
- Color:** Turquoise
- Active:** ☒
- Cyclic monitoring:** ☐
- Cyclic monitoring:** (Section header)
- Automatic: after reading the message:**
 - Active:** ☒
 - Function:** (Text field)
 - CLOSE:** (Text field)
- Automatic: after closing the event:** (Section header)
- Automatic: after sending the message:**
 - Active:** ☐
 - Function:** (Text field)
 - CLOSE:** (Text field)

Event tab for FZ.APPLICATION_REJECTED



The screenshot shows the 'Event' tab configuration for the event 'FZ.APPLICATION_REJECTED'. The configuration includes the following fields and options:

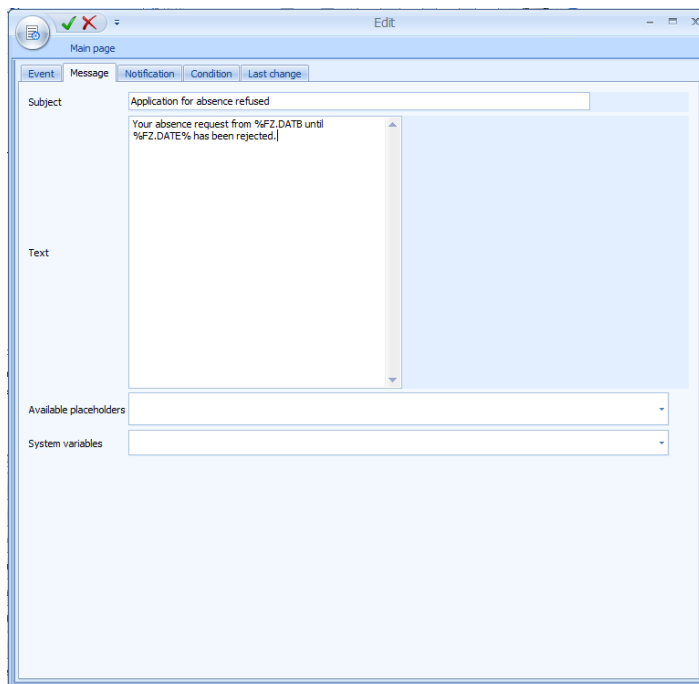
- Event:** FZ.APPLICATION_REJECTED
- Designation:** Application for absence refused
- Recipient type:** Function
- Recipient:** HYDRA-Administrator
- Priority:** 1
- Color:** Pink
- Active:** ☒
- Cyclic monitoring:** ☐
- Cyclic monitoring:** (Empty field)
- Automatic: after reading the message:**
 - Active:** ☒
 - Function:** (Dropdown menu)
 - CLOSE:** (Text field)
- Automatic: after closing the event:** (Empty field)
- Automatic: after sending the message:**
 - Active:** ☐
 - Function:** (Dropdown menu)
 - CLOSE:** (Text field)

Event tab for FZ.APPLICATION_WITHDRAWN

The entries in the *Message* and *Notification* tabs have the same settings as the approval of an absence request.

Message tab

You can define the subject and text of the message in the *Message* tab



The screenshot shows the 'Message' tab configuration. The configuration includes the following fields and options:

- Subject:** Application for absence refused
- Text:** Your absence request from %FZ.DATB until %FZ.DATE% has been rejected.
- Available placeholders:** (Dropdown menu)
- System variables:** (Dropdown menu)

Examples:

Person %FZ.PNR% %FZ.NAME:PNR% has requested %FZ.BEZL:ENTLTMOD% from %FZ.DATB date dd.mm.yyyy% to %FZ.DATE date dd.mm.yyyy%.

Your absence request for the period from %FZ.DATB date dd.mm.yyyy% to %FZ.DATE date dd.mm.yyyy% absence %FZ.ENTLTMOD% %FZ.BEZL:ENTLTMOD% has been approved.

Your absence request for the period from %FZ.DATB date dd.mm.yyyy% to %FZ.DATE date dd.mm.yyyy% absence %FZ.ENTLTMOD% %FZ.BEZL:ENTLTMOD% has been rejected.

The following placeholders are available for creating the message:

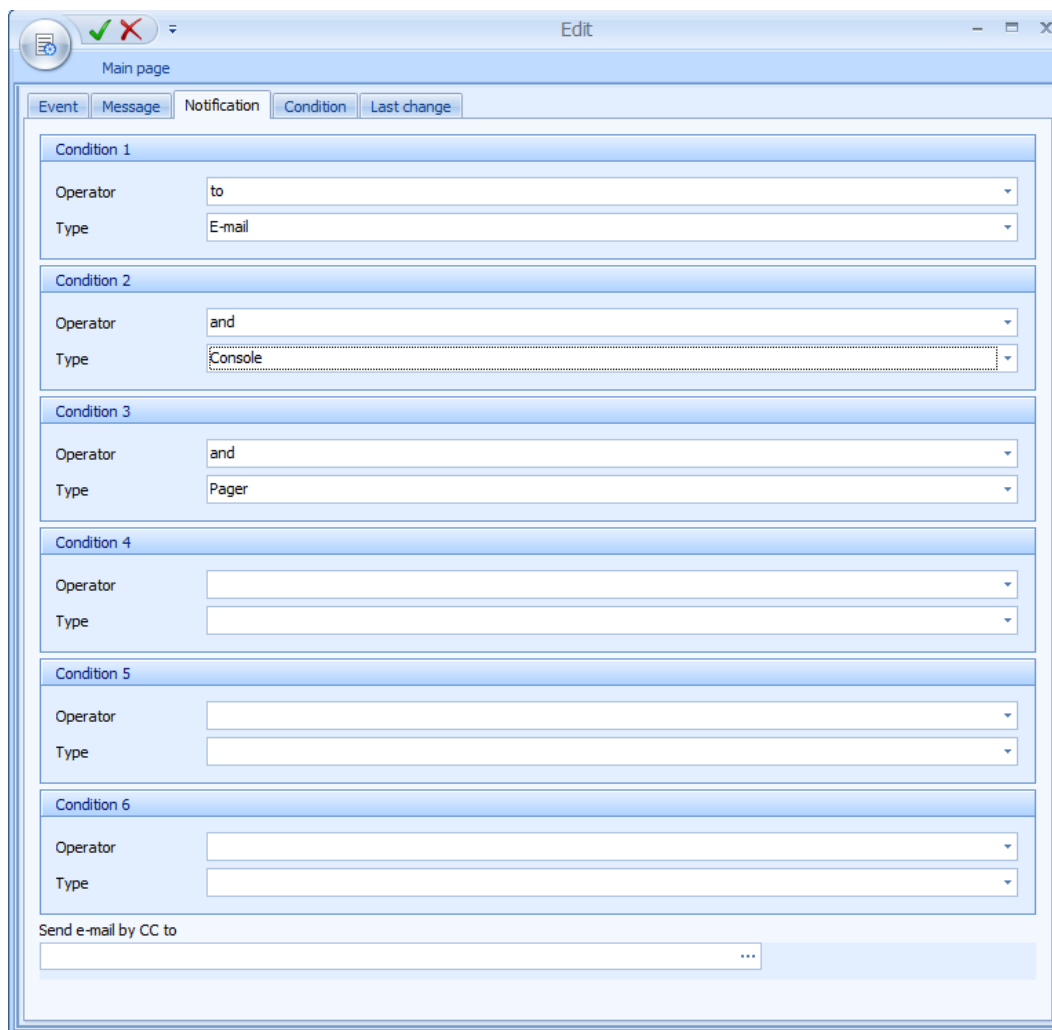
Event	Acronyms	Description
FZ.APPLICATION_FILED FZ.APPLICATION_ALLOWED FZ.APPLICATION_REJECTED FZ.APPLICATION_WITHDRAWN	FZ.DATB	Start date
	FZ.BEZL	Comment
	FZ.BEZL:ENTLTMOD	Absence designation
	FZ.VERWEIS	Unique record number
	FZ.DATE	End date
	FZ.ENTLTMOD	Absence payment
	FZ.FIR	Company from the absence planning
	FZ.BEZX:ENTLTMOD	Absence abbreviation
	FZ.PNR	Personnel number
	FZ.NAME:PNR	Person's name
	FZ.PNAME	Last name
	FZ.PVORNAME	First name
	PNR.BESCHVERH	Employment relationship
	PNR.TEL:FIR	Company phone
	PNR.EMAIL:FIR	E-mail (business)
	PNR.BER	Area
	PNR.KST	Cost center
	PNR.ABT	Department
	PNR.PKREIS	Employee subgroup
	PNR.TAETIGKEIT	The person's activity
	PNR.PNR:VGS	The supervisor's personnel number
	FZ.KAT	Absence category
	FZ.DAT:APPLY	Date of request
	FZ.ZEI:APPLY	Period of request
FZ.APPLICATION_ALLOWED FZ.APPLICATION_REJECTED	FZ.BEARB	Modified by
	FZ.NAME:BEARB	Editor name

Event	Acronyms	Description
FZ.APPLICATION_REJECTED	FZ.ESK:BEM	Reason of reject <i>This variable is only available on the HYDRA systems with at least Service Pack 9 (2016).</i>

Notification tab

You can configure how the message is sent in the *Notification* tab. You can see in the example below, that the notification is sent to the console (MOC) where the supervisor is logged on, and additionally by e-mail.

If the e-mail notification type is active, an additional field is shown. You can enter one or more valid e-mail addresses, separated by a comma, in the *Send e-mail by CC to* field. When the e-mail is sent to the recipient of the escalation, a copy goes to the CC addressee(s):





If a message cannot be sent to the recipient of the escalation by e-mail, no copy is sent to the CC addressee, either. This could be the case if he/she does not have any e-mail address. No e-mail notification is required for employees for whom no e-mail address is entered in the personnel master record.



This notification type is configured in a way that the message is displayed only once on the PZE terminal and is removed after a maximum of 4 weeks. However, the message can be displayed several times during the period of the cyclic loading of authorizations. The message is displayed with the following actions on the PZE terminal: In, out, break, info, message and absence reason.

Messages can only be displayed on terminals of the type CT-36x, CT-37x and CT-38x.

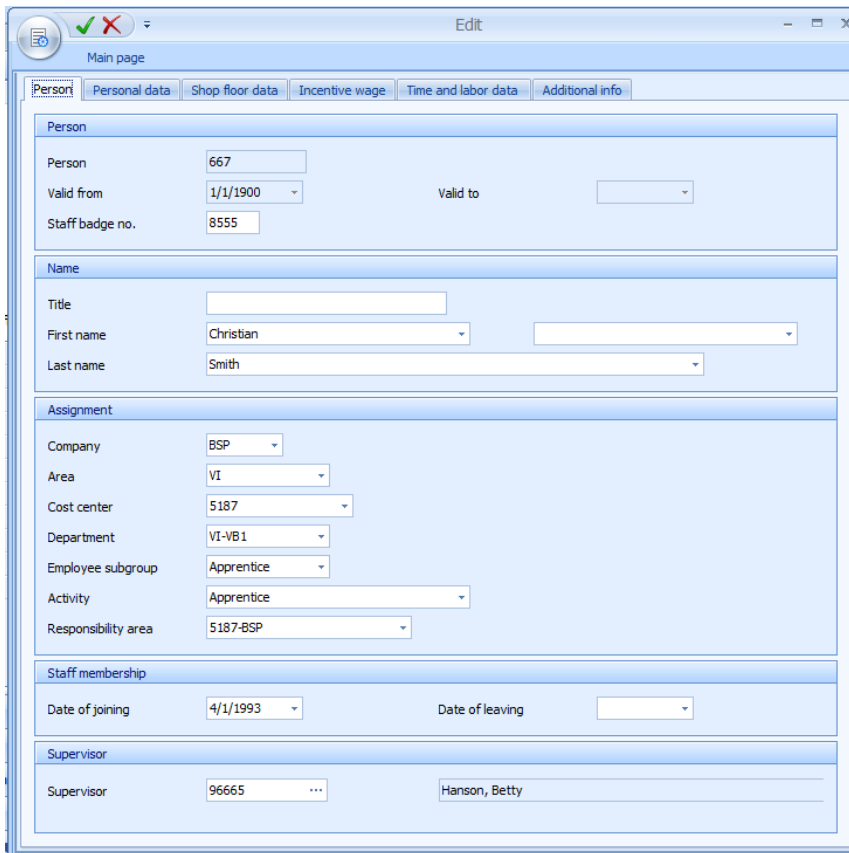
Data retention of escalations

By default, escalations are stored for 30 days. With absence requests, you must usually extend this period so that the request is still displayed when the absence only starts half a year later, for example.

Supervisor and E-mail Address Configuration

Menu	Master data → Staff → HR master data
Transaction code	Pers
Function authorization	Pers

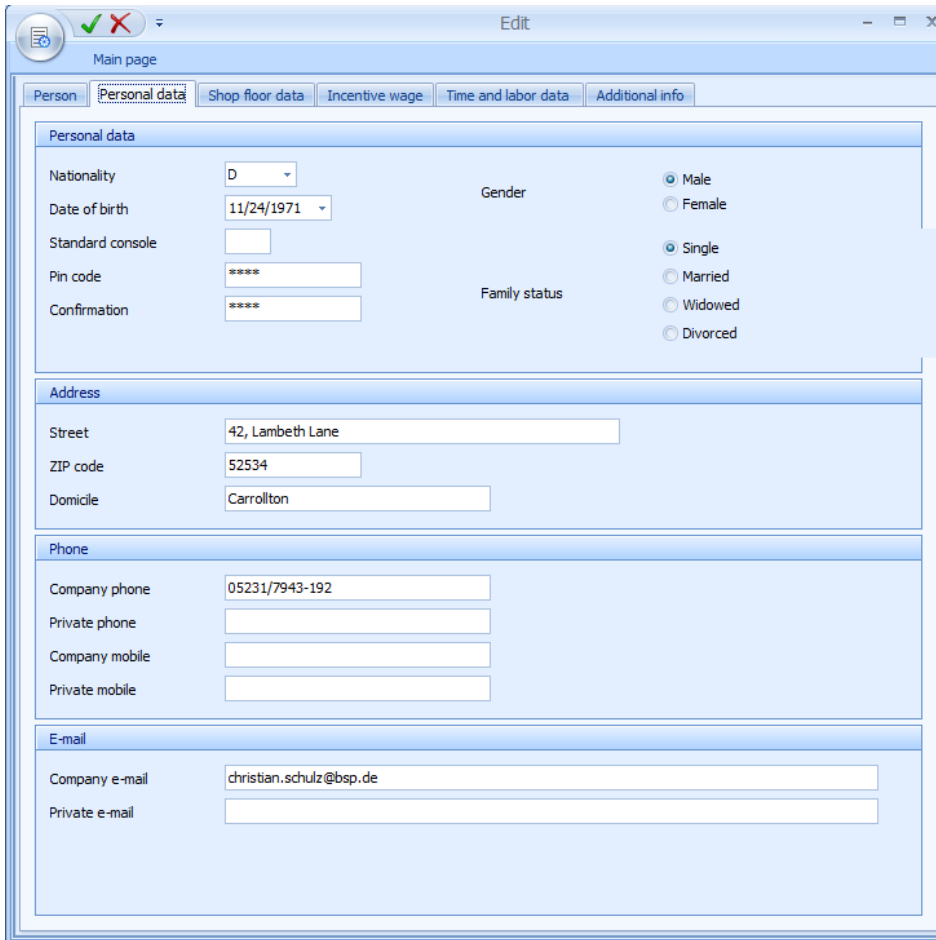
The person's supervisor is entered in the *Person* tab of the [HR master data](#). Absence times requested in the workflow are forwarded to this supervisor.



The screenshot shows the 'Person' tab of the HR master data form. The form is divided into several sections:

- Person:**
 - Person: 667
 - Valid from: 1/1/1900
 - Staff badge no.: 8555
- Name:**
 - Title:
 - First name: Christian
 - Last name: Smith
- Assignment:**
 - Company: BSP
 - Area: VI
 - Cost center: 5187
 - Department: VI-VB1
 - Employee subgroup: Apprentice
 - Activity: Apprentice
 - Responsibility area: 5187-BSP
- Staff membership:**
 - Date of joining: 4/1/1993
 - Date of leaving:
- Supervisor:**
 - Supervisor: 96665
 - Hanson, Betty

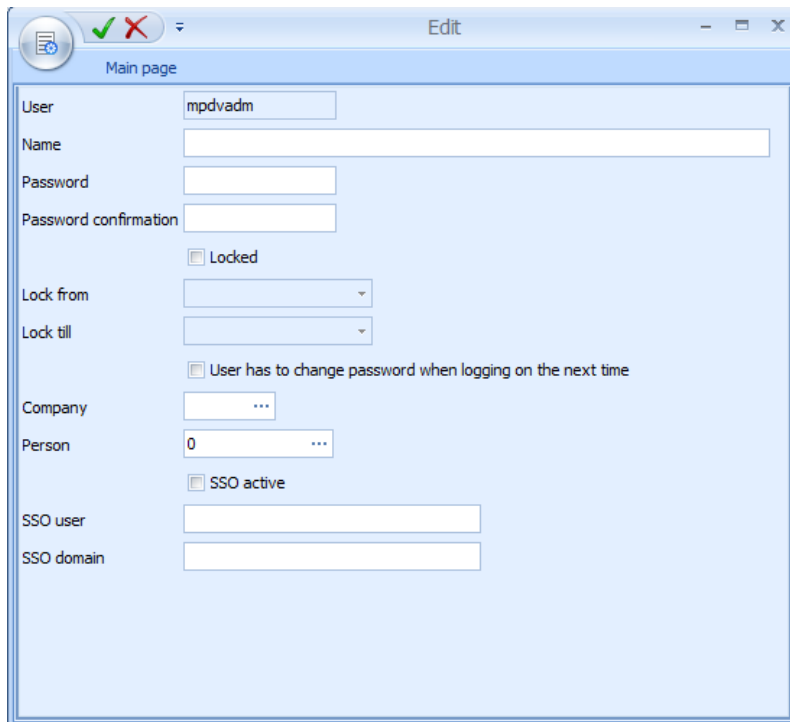
Enter the e-mail address in the *Company e-mail* field in the *Personal Data* tab for employees and supervisors that are notified by e-mail.



Allocation of Supervisor to HYDRA User

Menu	System administration → User administration → Users
Transaction code	user
Function authorization	user

When the supervisor logs on to the HYDRA MOC, the system displays the requests for absences in the *Current Escalations* window. For this to work, it is necessary to link the personnel number of the supervisor and the [User](#) number he/she uses to log on.



Company, Person

Assignment of the user to a person in the HR master data.

Control of Absence Times that are displayed

Menu	Master data → Labor time → Control of absence times
Transaction code	abse
Function authorization	abse

The absence times you can select in the *Absence workflow* are specified in the [Control of absences](#) window.

Day type	Designation	Full-day absence	Partly absent	Priority
400	Illness	Ill	Ill	60
420	School (full day)	Sch	Sch	30
450	Leave	Lea	Lea	50
451	Half day leave	HLD	HLD	50
455	Special Leave	FCI	FCI	55
480	Short-time work	STW	stiw	25
600	Holiday	PubH	PubH	70
610	Half day (Publ.H.)	F12	F12	70
901	Flextime minus	FLX	FLX	40

Control of absences - Settings

Options

- ☐ Authorization required
- ☐ Generate complete absence despite attendance
- ☐ Partly absent
- Fill up target time to: %
- ☒ Modification enabled
- ☒ Display as planned absent

Compensation

- ☒ Allocate actual time
- ☐ Allocate as undertime
- ☒ Allocate leave day
- ☐ Allocate half a leave day

Absence workflow

- ☒ Absence may be requested
- ☒ Request needs to be approved

Continued pay

Period of continued pay:

Subseq. payment:

Upload to payroll accounting

- ☒ Upload to payroll accounting
- Absence reason:
- Control indicator:

Absence may be requested

The button specifies whether you can select the absence time using the Web interface.

Request needs to be approved

This parameter is used to specify whether the absence time requested via the absence workflow must be approved by the supervisor or whether it is automatically approved.

3 Replacements

Overview

If the supervisor is absent and an absence request is made via absence workflow, then you can forward this absence request to the person replacing the supervisor (replacement).

The settings for the replacement configuration are made in different applications in HYDRA MOC:

Configuration – HR master data

Menu	Master data → Staff → HR master data
Transaction code	pers
Function authorization	pers.*

You specify the replacement of the supervisor in the application [HR master data](#).

Field descriptions

It is important to specify *Replacement 1* and *Replacement 2* in the HR master data of the relevant supervisor.

Replacement 1

Specifies the first person replacing the supervisor. You can use this field to specify the person that replaces the supervisor in case of absence. The absence workflow uses this field when a user replacing the supervisor is required.

Replacement 2

Specifies the second person replacing the supervisor. You can use this field to specify the person that replaces the supervisor and the first replacement in case of absence. The absence workflow uses this field when a user replacing the supervisor is required.

Configuration – INI configuration

Menu	System administration → System settings → INI configuration
Transaction code	inifg
Function authorization	inifg.*

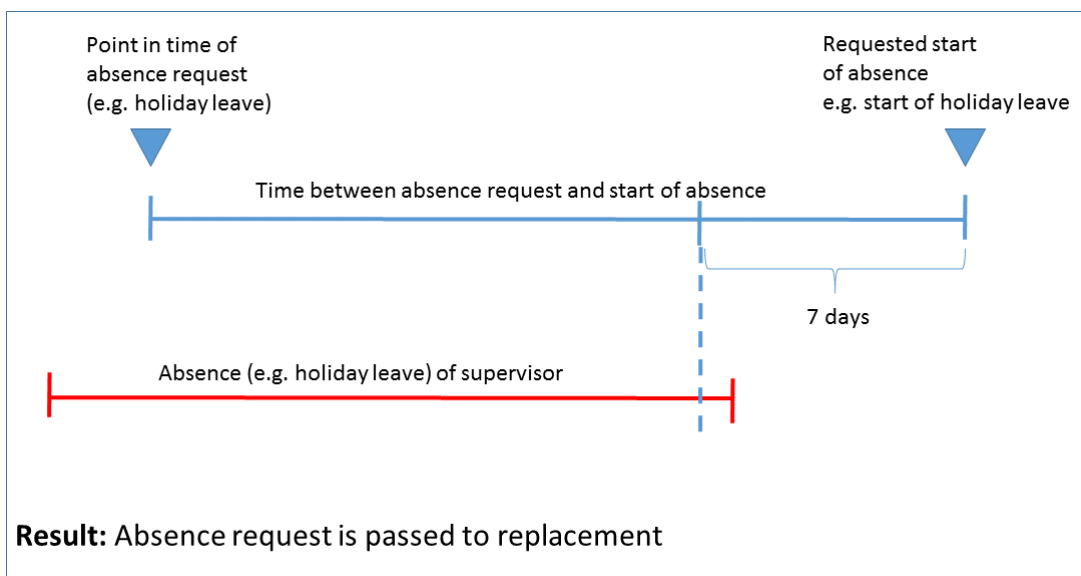
INI configuration:

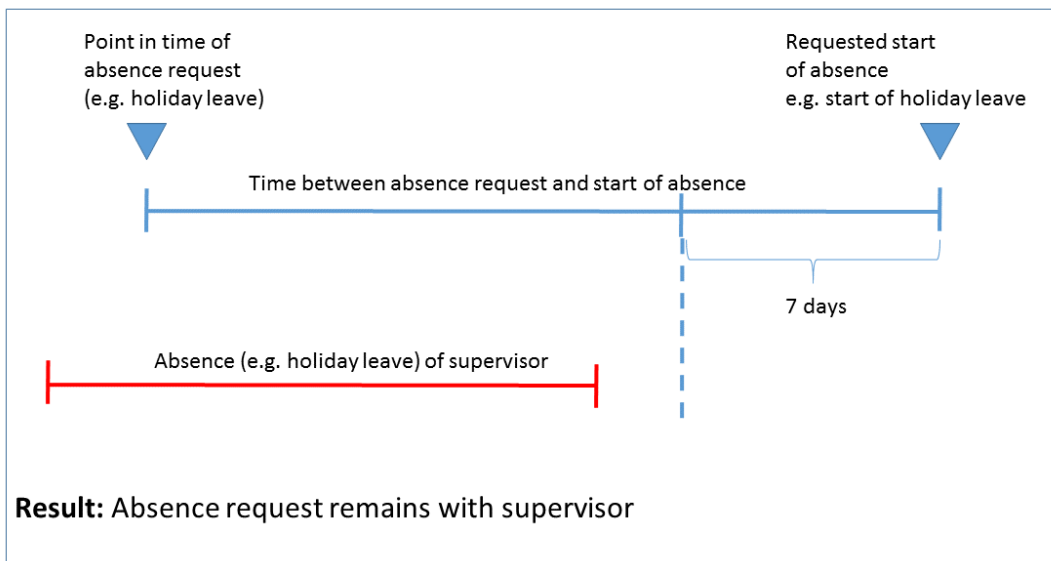
- Name: FORWARDING
- Section: WORKFLOW
- Key: DEPUTY
- Value: 7

By default, the value must be set to 7.

The INI configuration specifies that the supervisor must be available at least 7 days before start of the holiday leave of the person. Only then can the supervisor authorize or reject the request. If the supervisor cannot guarantee this because of an absence (e.g. holiday leave or sick leave), the absence request is sent to the first replacement. HYDRA uses the absence planning or the personnel scheduling to identify if a supervisor is available or not. If also the first person replacing the supervisor is not available these 7 days, then the absence request is sent to the second replacement.

Graphic presentation:





If the supervisor, the replacement and the second replacement are not available in the specified period (7 days), then the absence request is only sent to the supervisor.

4 Requesting Absences on the Terminal

Overview

Employees can use this function to request, change and delete absences on the PZE or BDE terminal. The terminal also provides an overview for the employee that displays the former requests and their request status.

Operation on the terminal

To start the absence planning on the PZE terminal, select the respective button and scan the badge. The following dialog opens and shows the requested, approved or planned absences.

Date from	Date till	Absence reason	Status
05.06.2012	05.06.2012	Urlaub	requested
14.06.2012	15.06.2012	Dienstreise	planned

On the BDE terminal, the dialog opens directly when you have pressed the respective button. To show the absences, you must first scan the badge. You cannot enter the staff badge number via keyboard. For security reasons, you must scan the badge via badge or bar code reader.

Note:

You can only use the function, if the terminal is online. If the terminal is offline, the request is canceled and an error message is output.

The list only shows planned absences of the future and the absence reasons that you can also request or plan on the terminal. The following statuses are shown:

Status	Description
requested	The absence has been requested, but has not yet been approved or refused.
approved	The absence has been requested and has been approved by the superior.
planned	The absence does not require approval and has been planned on the terminal or on the HYDRA client.



The list does not show the rejected requests. This way, the employee is not reminded again and again that they actually wanted to be off at a different time and that this request has been refused. The information that an absence request has been refused is shown when the employee clocks in or out on the PZE terminal (AIP or ctwin).

Function key assignment

Cancel

Use this button to close the dialog.

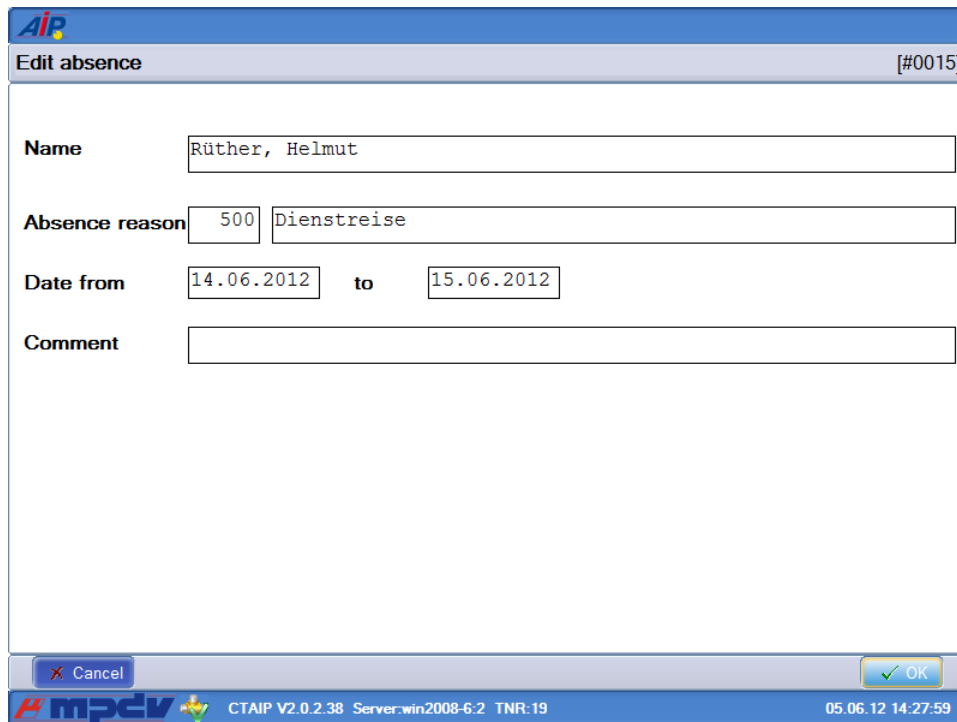
Request

To request an absence, the following dialog opens (P_FZP_INS):

Select an absence reason and enter a period. Click the button **OK** to request or plan the absence. You can also enter a comment.

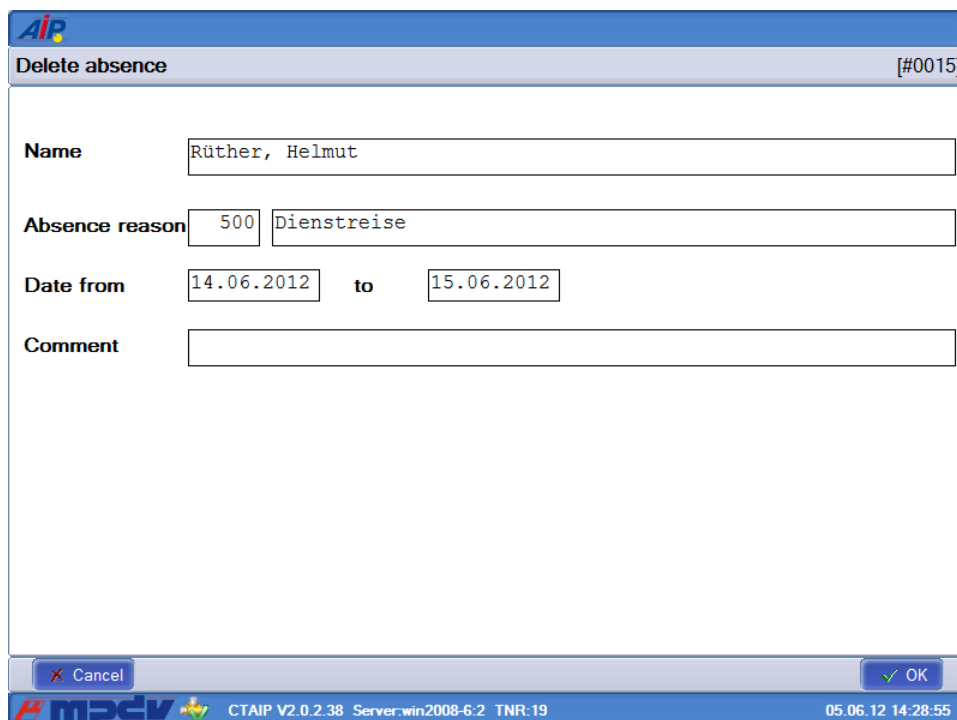
Edit

The employee can use the dialog *Edit absence* (P_FZP_UPD) to change a planned absence. This function is only available for absences that need not be approved:



Delete

The employee can use the dialog *Delete absence* (P_FZP_DEL) to delete a planned or requested absence. If an absence has been requested, the superior is informed that the request has been canceled:





The button *Delete* is only available for the following absences:

- requested and not yet approved absences;
- absences that do not require approval;
- absences that have been entered on the terminal.

Info

The employee can use this button to display the current account balances. The same display is shown if you press the *Info* button on the PZE terminal:

Information [00002006]		[#0009]	
	Designation	Value	
↑	Flextime	0:00	↑
	Overtime	0:00	
	Flex. time	0:00	
⏪	Leave Account	0.00	⏩
↓			↓
X Cancel		✓ OK	

Terminal configuration

On the PZE terminal, the functionality described can be enabled using an *Absence reason* button. In the terminal configuration, tab *HR functions*, assign the entry "_FZP" to one of the fields *Absence reason 1* to *Absence reason 4*. You can define the label text of the respective button on the PZE terminal in one of the fields *Absence reason text 1* to *Absence reason text 4*.

On the BDE terminal, you can enable the functionality using the dynamic dialog P_FZP. The following entry is made in any section of the INI file ctaipbut.ini:

X=P_FZP,R,*button label* (X = button index)

Activating dynamic dialogs

To call the dialog on the terminal, the dynamic dialog *P_FZP* must be enabled. The dialog is usually enabled during installation of the system. If this is not the case, you can enable the dialog in the application [Dynamic dialogs](#) using the button *Activate dialog*.



You can define dynamic dialogs for terminals or terminal groups. This option is mainly used on BDE terminals. If you want to use the absence workflow on a terminal where dialogs for the terminal or the terminal group exist, you must copy and enable the dialogs *P_FZP*, *P_FZP_INS*, *P_FZP_UPD* and *P_FZP_DEL* for the terminal or the terminal group.

5 Approval and Rejection of Absence Requests

Overview

Absence requests are approved and rejected in the MOC via [absence planning](#) and [personnel scheduling](#).

5.1 Approval and rejection in absence planning

For approving and/or rejecting an absence request in [absence planning](#), select the relevant absence; then click one of the following buttons in the toolbar:



Approve request

Function authorization: pabp.sign

This button is used to approve a requested absence. Further processing is executed in the same way as for approving a request in escalation management.



Reject request

Function authorization: pabp.reject

This button is used to reject a requested absence. Further processing is executed in the same way as for rejecting a request in escalation management.

5.2 Approval and rejection in personnel scheduling

For approving and/or rejecting an absence request in [personnel scheduling](#), select a day of the relevant absence, open the context menu by right clicking and choose the function *Approve request* and/or *Reject request* in the submenu *Absence* of the context menu:

